

Pokémon Ash Gray — Foolproof **HARDCORE** RetroAchievements Guide

For RA set #5245 "*~Hack~ Pokémon AshGray Version*" — 139 achievements / 686 points, GBA, beta 4.5.3.

This guide is built from two sources, kept honestly separate:

- **Our reverse-engineering audit** of the game's code (authoritative on the *bugs* — exactly which boxes corrupt saves, where the crashes are, and the precise player-side action that dodges each).
- **The RA community guide** (RA forum topic 2211 + the official achievement list) — authoritative on the *missables and order*. Where the community couldn't confirm something, it's flagged UNVERIFIED.

The core trade you've accepted: Hardcore credit requires the *unmodified* ROM, so every bug we patched in the fork is still live here. This guide turns each of our fixes into a thing **you** do by hand. The single most bulletproof option would be to play our fork (all bugs fixed) — but that forfeits credit. For *credited hardcore*, discipline replaces the patch. That's what this is.

★ THE SURVIVAL CARD (read this even if you read nothing else)

1. **NEVER store a Pokémon in the 2nd, 3rd, or 6th box** (BOX 2 / BOX 3 / BOX 6). Use 1, 4, 5, 7-14.

This one rule prevents the save-corruption that silently breaks gym badges, story events, and fast-travel, and spawns Bad Eggs. It is the #1 cause of "my game broke and I don't know why."

2. **In-game SAVE before every gym, cutscene, named event, and achievement attempt.**
Keep rotating

backup copies of your .sav file between sessions (the community endorses this for this set).

3. **Do EVERY Kanto achievement and beat the Elite Four BEFORE leaving for the Orange Islands.**

There is **no way back to Kanto**. Don't go wandering south with Surf+Cut until Kanto is 100% done.

4. **Keep a party slot open** at the Breeding Centre Team Rocket scene (full party = crash).
5. **Don't evolve** Charmander / Squirtle / Pidgeotto until their event fires (see §5). (*Bulbasaur — evolve anytime.*)
6. **Don't let Pikachu faint** in a Team Rocket battle — it permanently stops obeying you.

 **Just want to follow along while you play?** Jump to §8 — the **Sequential Play-Order Checklist** at the bottom: it interleaves every catch, evolution, crash, missable, and save point in game order. §1-§5 are the reference / *why* behind it.

1. Setup — make sure it actually counts

1. Get the RA-supported ROM. The standard Ash Gray **4.5.3** ROM (commonly-cited MD5 92262059190c05a5615be6b98612fb14) is what the set targets. **Do NOT use our fork** — its hash is 04d28f01..., which RA will not recognize, so nothing would count.

- **Foolproof check:** load the ROM in your RA emulator. If it's recognized (you see the game

title

and "139 achievements"), you have the right file. If it says *unknown/unsupported*, your ROM is the wrong dump — get the RA-supported version (RA distributes the correct file/patch).

2. Emulator: an RA-enabled one — **RetroArch** with the **mGBA** core and the Achievements option

enabled, or an official RA standalone. **Turn Hardcore Mode ON** and log into your RA account *before* loading the game (toggling hardcore mid-session resets the game).

3. Hardcore rules (what you're allowed):

-  Allowed: in-game **Save**, **Soft Reset**, fast-forward, and **backing up your .sav file** between sessions.

-  Forbidden: **savestates**, cheats/codes/Game Genie, rewind, slowdown. (Loading a savestate instantly drops you to softcore for the session.)

2. **BOX DISCIPLINE — the save-killer (D1). This is rule #1 for a reason.**

Never store a Pokémon in the 2nd, 3rd, or 6th box of the PC. Safe boxes: **1, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14**. When *depositing*, also don't let the "Deposit in which BOX?" selector land on box 2/3/6 — pick a safe box explicitly.

Why (the mechanism we proved): Ash Gray stores its extended story-progress *variables* in memory that **physically overlaps the PC box storage**. Depositing a Pokémon into box 2/3/6 overwrites those variables. Confirmed consequences (several reproduced in-engine):

- **Gym badges break.** Boulder, Cascade, Marsh, and Volcano badge paths are gated on box-3 variables.

Corrupt them and the gym routes to filler dialogue instead of the battle/badge — you end up a badge short on a gym you *thought* you beat. (We live-reproduced Sabrina going completely inert.)

- **Events re-trigger / soft-lock.** The opening Spearow chase re-forces forever; the Mt. Moon / Seymour scene re-fires; the PokéCenter fast-travel ("teleport markers") stops working.

- **Orange-Islands gym progress** lives in **box 6** — corrupt it and the OI gym chain breaks.

- **Bad Eggs.** A real Pokémon parked in a hazard box gets its data overwritten → checksum fails → Bad Egg.

The RA community guide only warns about **box 3**. Our audit found **box 2's tail and box 6 are hazards too** — so this guide reserves all three. (Box 6 is the Orange-Islands one, which matters for the late game.) Following this rule makes you *safer than the community's own advice*.

3. **SAVE DISCIPLINE — surviving the crashes & soft-locks**

Universal rule: **Save in-game before every event, and keep rotating .sav backups.** Below is the audit-derived landmine map with the *specific* action that dodges each one. (Confidence note: these bugs are confirmed in beta 4.5.3, which is what the RA set is based on. The RA-distributed build

might have patched a few — if you never hit one, great; saving first costs nothing.)

M1

Hazard: **Ledge-prison softlock** (permanent, ~2 screens in!)

Where / when: Pallet Town, the south wall of Oak's Lab

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Don't press UP against the lab wall one tile to the right of the door.** That tile ledge-hops you east into a 1-tile dead pocket with no exit. Enter the lab from directly below the door.

F1

Hazard: **Forest battle freeze** (engine-level, intermittent)

Where / when: Viridian Forest scripted Caterpie / Pidgeotto battles

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Save before entering the forest.** If it freezes (black screen, input dead), **soft reset** and refight — it's non-deterministic and clears on a retry.

L5

Hazard: **Hidden Village pit** (no exit)

Where / when: Hidden Village (Bulbasaur area) — off-color grass patches

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Carry an Escape Rope** (or a Pokémon with Dig). Avoid the differently-colored grass; if you fall in, Escape Rope out.

L2

Hazard: **Oak full-party stall** (blocks league departure)

Where / when: Prof. Oak's lab, league day, getting your watched Pokémon back

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Have an open party slot** when you talk to Oak that day, so he can hand the Pokémon over and trigger the send-off.

L1

Hazard: **Indigo gate: "league hasn't begun"** (blocks the E4)

Where / when: Indigo Plateau gate, after badges + exam

****What YOU do to survive it**:** The gate opens on a **league-start event** (a video-phone / Prof. Oak scene), *not* the exam. Make sure you've triggered that story beat; don't skip the pre-league phone call.

F3

Hazard: **Breeding Centre crash** (blocks Cinnabar/main quest)

Where / when: "Secret of the Breeding Centre" — talking to Jessie & James, then Butch & Cassidy

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Keep a party slot open (≤5 Pokémon)** before talking to them. The crash only fires with a full party.

F4

Hazard: **Excavation pickaxe softlock**

Where / when: Grampa Canyon, getting the pickaxe (the rival hands it over)

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Save right before.** If the rival walks off and you can't move, **soft reset** and retry. (Honest: this is a scripted-movement collision; reset-retry is the clean-ROM tool. See the emergency hatch in §6 if it won't clear.)

F2

Hazard: **Underwater-cave freeze** (black screen)

Where / when: New Island / Dragonite arc, the raft crossing

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Take the normal story raft crossing** (it sets up the scene correctly) and **save before** the crossing. Don't try to reach that cave by side doors.

L9

Hazard: **Raft soft-lock** (unwinnable)

Where / when: Dragonite's invitation to Mewtwo's island

****What YOU do to survive it**:** **Accept the invitation.** Declining leaves the raft/island in a dead state with no recovery — you can neither progress nor return.

L13

Hazard: **Cerulean Gym pier softlock** (one step)

Where / when: Cerulean Gym (Misty), the diving-board / pier tip over the water

****What YOU do to survive it**:** Don't step out onto the very tip of the diving board over the pool; the rim tile there can trap you in a one-room gym. Save before the gym.

F6

Hazard: **Tangelo Park "back of building" void**

Where / when: Orange Islands — the Pokémon Park building

***What YOU do to survive it**:* **Save before.** If you get escorted through a wall into the void, soft reset.

F7

Hazard: **OI "lady" event crash** (unconfirmed)

Where / when: Orange Islands — the Nastina/Tentacruel or Maiden's-Peak lady scenes

***What YOU do to survive it**:* Precautionary: **save before Orange-Islands cutscenes.** We could not confirm a hard crash here, but the report exists; a save costs nothing.

Also expect, by design (not bugs): Charizard won't obey until the Orange-Islands "Charizard Chills" event ("Defeat Tad..."); some Pokémon refuse orders in specific scripted fights. Don't reset over these — they're intended.

4. MISSABLE DISCIPLINE — the point of no return & the checklist

The one hard wall

Finish 100% of Kanto — every sidequest achievement — and beat the Elite Four BEFORE you leave for the Orange Islands. The game *"was never completed past the Orange Islands and there is no way back to Kanto."* Worse, the transition is **not a locked door** — once you have **Surf + Cut** you can physically wander into Orange-Islands water and strand yourself with Kanto achievements unearned. So:

don't explore the southern sea routes until your Kanto checklist is done. Everything after the

"Where it all began" achievement (the post-Championship sky battle) is Orange-Islands content.

The authoritative 42 missables (RA "missable" filter — confirmed 2026-06-14)

Grouped in rough play order. ⚠️ = **needs a specific Pokémon, a deliberate loss, or a one-time choice.** Save before every one of these, no exceptions.

A. Kanto journey (14)

Prepare for Trouble...

What it needs: Defeat Team Rocket in the **Viridian Pokémon Center**

Watch-out: Very early (the Pikachu-vs-TR scene). *Not the forest — that's the non-missable "Make It Double."*

Give Me Back My Pokémon!

What it needs: Get your **Metapod back from the Beedrill**

Watch-out: Viridian Forest — don't rush through

Unbeaten

What it needs: Defeat **AJ** in his mini-gym

Watch-out: One-time roadside gym (AJ's win streak)

Elder vs. Child ⚠️

What it needs: **LOSE** to **Lt. Surge** 1-on-1 with **Pikachu**

Watch-out: Deliberate loss — do it *before* winning the gym

Worth the \$500 ⚠️

What it needs: **Choose Magikarp** from the salesman / vs Team Rocket on the **St. Anne**

Watch-out: One-time choice, no rematch

The Kraken

What it needs: Defeat the **giant Tentacruel**

Watch-out: Porta Vista / Nastina sea event

Shed a Tear ⚠️

What it needs: Look at **all 4 Pokémon in the abandoned house** without adopting any

Watch-out: Don't adopt, don't leave early — exact

No More Monkey Business ⚠️

What it needs: **Capture** the **Primeape** that stole your hat

Watch-out: Catch it, don't just beat it

Sludge Monster ⚠️

What it needs: **Capture** the **Muk** in the Power Plant

Watch-out: You need this Muk for League R4 (below)

Santa Is Real

What it needs: Meet **Santa** in the North Pole

Watch-out: One-time event

Cold Together

What it needs: Bring a **friend** (keep a party slot) to a **Snow Island** cave

Watch-out: —

An Absolute Unit ⚠️

What it needs: **Capture Snorlax** and end the drought

Watch-out: Catch it (Wake-Up-Snorlax dam)

Wrong Meowth ⚠️

What it needs: Catch the **wrong Meowth** (in the grass) for Tommy

Watch-out: The "correct" one is by the house; you want the grass one

Pokémon Whiz Kid ⚠️

What it needs: Pass the **Pokémon-League exam** with a **perfect score**

Watch-out: Can't retake; reported flaky — save & verify the pop

B. Mewtwo's New Island — "Pokémon Palace" (5)

⚠️ **ACCEPT Dragonite's invitation.** Declining both strands you (our **L9** soft-lock) **and** skips all 5 of these one-time battles.

Water Battle

What it needs: Defeat **Fergus** in the Pokémon Palace

Not The Right Mix

What it needs: Defeat **Corey** in the Pokémon Palace

Not-So-Normal Type

What it needs: Defeat **Neesha** in the Pokémon Palace

Giant Onix

What it needs: Help **Bruno** capture an Onix

Become a Pokéhuman

What it needs: Get **trapped in a giant Pokéball**

C. Cinnabar / Blaine (3) — order-sensitive

Just Like in the Game

What it needs: Defeat **Blaine in the volcano**

Freezer Bomb

What it needs: Defeat **Team Rocket in the volcano**

Just Like in the Anime ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Blaine on TOP** of the volcano with **Charizard** — you must **lose once** to unlock the top fight

D. The Indigo League gauntlet (17) — almost half the missable list

One long chain of one-time battles. **Enter the League with all five of these ready: Kingler · an un-evolved Squirtle · Pikachu · Muk · Charizard.** Each tournament round pairs a "win" with a "win using a specific Pokémon":

First Taste Of Success

What it needs: Beat **Mandi** (round 1)

Easy League Start ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Mandi** (R1) **with Kingler**

Acting Like He Won the Competition

What it needs: Beat **Kevin** (round 2)

Skull Bashing Kevin ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Kevin** (R2) **with Squirtle**

Ice Field Triumph

What it needs: Beat **Pete** (round 3)

Water and Electricity ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Pete** (R3) **with Pikachu**

Beltastic

What it needs: Beat **Jeanette** (round 4)

Fourth Round Muk Day ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Jeanette** (R4) **with Muk**

We Really Won? ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Richie** (round 5)

Oh, We Lost... ⚠

What it needs: **LOSE** to **Richie** (R5) using **Charizard last**

Beat the One Who Beat Gary

What it needs: Beat **Melissa** (semifinal)

You Are the Champion!

What it needs: Beat **Gideon** (final)

Ice-Cold Master

What it needs: Beat **Lorelei** (Elite Four)

Solid-Ground Fighter

What it needs: Beat **Bruno** (Elite Four)

Spirit-Tamed Elder

What it needs: Beat **Agatha** (Elite Four)

Dragon-Fierce Warrior

What it needs: Beat **Lance** (Elite Four)

You Were Ready!

What it needs: Beat **Slate** (the Champion)

⚠ **The Richie fork — your single most important backup-save point.** *We Really Won?* (win) and *Oh, We Lost...* (lose with Charizard last) are **opposite outcomes of the same one-time**

battle — you cannot get both in one run normally, and losing likely ends your tournament run (skipping Melissa/Gideon/Elite Four). **Back up your .sav right before round 5:** throw the match on the backup for *Oh, We Lost...*, then restore and win through on your main file. (Same gray-area .sav practice as §6 — the purist alternative is a second playthrough.)

E. Post-Championship → Orange Islands (3)

Where It All Began ⚠

What it needs: Defeat **Fearow** in the **sky battle**

Watch-out: Need a **Pidgeot** in your party after the Championship, or it won't fire — the gateway out of Kanto

Seadra Challenge ⚠

What it needs: Beat **Cissy** (Mikan gym) with **Squirtle**

Watch-out: Carry the **un-evolved Squirtle** across the point of no return

How Hungry? ⚠

What it needs: Catch the **Snorlax** on **Grapaberry Island** (stop it eating berries)

Watch-out: Orange Islands — catch it

This is the complete 42 (pulled straight from RA's missable filter, 2026-06-14). $14+5+3+17+3 = 42$.

NOT missable — stop worrying about these: *Bye Bye Butterfree* (yellow-scarf release), *The Movie of the Century* (Lights-Camera-Quack-tion), *Set Off the Sprinklers* (Pewter Gym), *Make It Double* (Team Rocket in Viridian Forest), and gaining *the trust of Lapras* are all **non-[m]** — you can't permanently lose them. The old community guide's "*Haha A Baby*" and "*Stand up for Bulbasaur*" are **not** in the current 42 (likely renamed) — don't chase them.

Don't confuse this set with the separate hack "~Hack~ Pokémon: Orange Islands" (RA #14483) — its achievements (I'm Really Thad, Fields of Victory, Master of Many, Wave Rider / Coral-Eye Badge, etc.) are **NOT** in Ash Gray.

5. TEAM PLANNING — Pokémon you must catch / not evolve (now tied to the real 42)

The authoritative missable list pins down *exactly* which Pokémon you must have ready, and which to keep un-evolved. Build toward this:

- **Squirtle — keep it UN-EVOLVED** all the way into the Orange Islands. Two missables need the *species*

Squirtle: **Skull Bashing Kevin** (League round 2) and **Seadra Challenge** (Cissy, Ol Gym 1). Carry it un-evolved across the point of no return.

- **Charmander → Charizard — have Charizard by Cinnabar/League.** Needed for **Just Like in the Anime**

(Blaine's top fight) and **Oh, We Lost...** (the Richie loss). Community timing: don't evolve until the North Pole cave event, and have it as Charizard by the Grampa Canyon excavation.

- **Pidgeotto → Pidgeot — have a Pidgeot in your party after the Championship** for **Where It All Began**

(the Fearow sky battle). No Pidgeot, no sky battle.

- **Catch a Muk** (Power Plant) — that's **Sludge Monster**, and you need it for **Fourth Round Muk Day**

(League round 4).

- **Have a Kingler** (evolve a Krabby) for **Easy League Start** (League round 1).
- **Keep Pikachu** central — **Elder vs. Child** (lose to Surge with Pikachu) and **Water and**

Electricity

(beat Pete with Pikachu) both need it.

Correction vs the old community guide: **Bulbasaur evolution timing is NOT enforced by a missable** — "Stand up for Bulbasaur" isn't in the real 42, so you can evolve Bulbasaur whenever. (Holding evolutions until after an anime-significant Pokémon's signature event is still a safe habit, just not required here.)

6. Emergency anti-brick hatch (gray area — last resort only)

If a clean-ROM **crash/softlock won't clear with reset-retry** (the realistic risk is F4 excavation), there is a recovery path that loses you *nothing* legitimately:

Because our fork and the clean ROM share an **identical save format**, the **same .sav file loads in both**. So you can: copy your .sav → open it in **our fork** (which fixes that exact bug) → walk through *only* the one broken event → save → copy the .sav back to the clean ROM and continue your hardcore run.

Honesty flag: this earns **no achievement** on the fork — it only un-bricks you past a developer bug. RA cannot detect it (a .sav is the game's own battery save, not a savestate, and no unlock happens on the fork). But it *is* using a modified binary to pass an obstacle, which hardcore purists would frown on. Use it **only** to rescue a run from an otherwise-unrecoverable softlock — never to gain an advantage. If purity matters more to you than the run, the alternative is to abandon and restart from your last good .sav backup.

7. Sources & confidence

- **Bugs, box discipline, crash avoidances:** our own reverse-engineering audit (ISSUES.md, audit/d1-pss-reserve-scoping.md, audit/d1-gym-badge-blocks.md). Many items (box-3 badge blocks, M1, F2-F6, L9, L13) were reproduced in-engine on the headless rig.
- **Missables, order, evolution timing:** RA community guide — forum topic 2211 (<https://retroachievements.org/viewtopic.php?t=2211&c=160218>) · RA game #5245 (<https://retroachievements.org/game/5245>) · beta 4.5.3 walkthrough (Google Doc) (https://docs.google.com/document/d/e/2PACX-1vQDOjM985v0brdtgbUGdwdzj_qa53Nq8ZxdkqwG6OgEFsw)
- **Honest gaps:** all 42 [m] missables are now enumerated (§4, straight from RA's filter). What's still soft: the RA-distributed build *may* have patched a subset of the §3 crashes; the exact in-game order of the late game (§8 stops 19-26) is anime-order + our audit, since the walkthrough cut off at Cinnabar; and "Shed a Tear" couldn't be pinned to a precise stop. None of these affect the box-discipline or point-of-no-return rules, which are the run-savers.

8. SEQUENTIAL PLAY-ORDER CHECKLIST — follow this top-to-bottom

Everything above, merged into one timeline. **Kanto (stops 1-18) is from the authoritative 4.5.3 walkthrough; the late game (19-26) is anime-order + our audit because the walkthrough cut off at Cinnabar — confirm exact sequence in-game there.** Legend: 🌀 missable · 🐞 catch · 🌈 evolution timing · ⚠️ crash/softlock · 💾 save · 📦 box rule.

📦 **Standing rule for the entire game:** never deposit a Pokémon in **BOX 2 / 3 / 6**. It's not repeated below — just never do it.

1. Pallet Town — get Pikachu from Oak.

- ⚠️ M1: don't press UP against the lab wall one tile *right* of the door (permanent softlock). Enter from directly below the door.

2. Route 1 → Viridian City (Pokémon Center)

- 📁🎯 **Prepare for Trouble...** — beat Team Rocket in the Viridian PC.
- ⚠️ Don't let **Pikachu faint** in this (or any) Team Rocket fight — permanent disobedience.

3. Route 2 / Viridian Forest

- 📁⚠️ **F1:** save before the forest; if it black-screens, soft reset & refight (intermittent).
- 🦋 Catch **Pidgeotto** (→ your future Pidgeot). 🎯 **Give Me Back My Pokémon!** — get your Metapod back from the Beedrill.

4. Pewter City — Brock. Freebie (non-missable): **Set Off the Sprinklers.**

5. Mt. Moon → Cerulean City — Misty

- ⚠️ **L13:** don't step onto the tip of the diving board over the pool (one-step softlock). 📁 Save before the gym.

6. Route 19 — AJ. 🎯 **Unbeaten** — defeat AJ's undefeated mini-gym.

7. Route 20 (Tech Institute) → Route 5

- 🦋 Catch **Charmander** (the abandoned one) + **Bulbasaur**. 🦋 **Don't evolve Charmander yet** (Bulbasaur: anytime).

8. Hidden Village. ⚠️ **L5:** carry an **Escape Rope** (or Dig); avoid the off-color grass pits.

9. Bill's Lighthouse → Vermilion City — Lt. Surge

- 🎯 **Elder vs. Child** ⚠️ — **LOSE** to Surge 1-on-1 with **Pikachu** *first*, then win the gym.
- 🦋 Once you get **Squirtle** (Squirtle Squad, around here), **keep it un-evolved all game** (*exact pickup point varies*).

10. S.S. Anne. 🎯 **Worth the \$500** ⚠️ — **choose Magikarp** from the salesman. Grab **Cut** here.

11. Pokémon Island → Porta Vista. 🎯 **The Kraken** — defeat the giant Tentacruel.

12. Maiden's Peak. ⚠️ F7 (precaution): 📁 save before the ghost/lady scene.

13. Route 7 → Saffron — Sabrina (lose) → Lavender/Pokémon Tower (Haunter) → Saffron rematch (win)

- Freebie: **Bye Bye Butterfree** (Route 7 release).
 - 📁 Extra-critical here: a Box-3 deposit makes **Sabrina go inert → no Marsh Badge**.
- ## 14. Route 7 (revisit). 🎯 **No More Monkey Business** ⚠️ — **capture** the Primeape that stole your hat.

15. Celadon — Erika → P1 Grand Prix (Route 13) → Gringey City (Power Plant)

- 🎯 **Sludge Monster** ⚠️ — **capture the Muk**. 🦋 Keep it — League round 4 needs it.

16. Diglett's Tunnel → Route 9 — Koga → Fuchsia → Safari Zone

- 🎯 **Wrong Meowth** ⚠️ — catch the **grass** Meowth for Tommy (*not* the one by the house).
- 🦋 Get a **Krabby** → **Kingler** around here (League round 1 needs Kingler).

17. Route 11 → Sunny Town → North Pole

- 🎯 **Santa Is Real** (meet Santa) · 🎯 **Cold Together** (bring a party-mate into a Snow Island cave).
- 🦋 **Charmander evolution window opens** (North Pole cave) — start evolving toward Charizard.

18. Route 12 cluster — Pikachu reunion → Eevee Bros → Snorlax dam → Dark City → Grampa Canyon

- 🎯 **An Absolute Unit** ⚠️ — **capture Snorlax** (end the drought).
- ⚠️ **F4 (Grampa Canyon):** 📁 save right before the pickaxe handoff; if you freeze after, soft reset & retry (§6 hatch if truly stuck).
- 🦋 **Have Charizard by the end of this cluster** (needed at Cinnabar & the League).

🔪 Walkthrough cuts off here. Stops 19–26 are anime-order + audit — order may shuffle; confirm in-game.

19. Pokémon League exam (The Ultimate Test). 🎯 **Pokémon Whiz Kid** ⚠️ — perfect score. 💾 Save before; reported flaky — verify the pop; no retake.

20. Secret of the Breeding Centre. ⚠️ **F3: keep a party slot open (≤5)** before talking to Jessie & James / Butch & Cassidy (full party = crash that blocks Cinnabar).

21. Cinnabar Island — Blaine (order-sensitive). 💾 Save before each:

- 🎯 **Just Like in the Game** (Blaine in the volcano) · 🎯 **Freezer Bomb** (Team Rocket in the volcano) · 🎯 **Just Like in the Anime** ⚠️ (Blaine **on top** with **Charizard** — you must **lose once** to open the top fight).

22. Viridian Gym — Giovanni / Earth Badge / Mewtwo intro.

23. Mewtwo's New Island — "Pokémon Palace" (*placement uncertain — may fall around/after the League*)

- ⚠️ **L9: ACCEPT Dragonite's invitation** (declining = unwinnable). ⚠️ **F2:** take the normal raft crossing; 💾 save before.
- 🎯 5 one-time battles: **Water Battle** (Fergus) · **Not The Right Mix** (Corey) · **Not-So-Normal Type** (Neesha) · **Giant Onix** (help Bruno) · **Become a Pokéhuman** (giant Pokéball).

24. League day — Prof. Oak → Indigo gate

- ⚠️ **L2: keep a party slot open** so Oak can return your watched Pokémon (else the send-off won't fire).
- ⚠️ **L1:** make sure the **league-start event** (phone/Oak scene) happened, or the gate guard blocks you despite badges.
- 🧬 Confirm a **Pidgeot** is in your party for after the Championship.

25. Indigo League — bring Kingler · un-evolved Squirtle · Pikachu · Muk · Charizard

- R1 Mandi → **First Taste Of Success + Easy League Start** (Kingler)
- R2 Kevin → **Acting Like He Won the Competition + Skull Bashing Kevin** (Squirtle)
- R3 Pete → **Ice Field Triumph + Water and Electricity** (Pikachu)
- R4 Jeanette → **Beltastic + Fourth Round Muk Day** (Muk)
- ⚠️ **R5 Richie** — 💾 **BACK UP YOUR SAVE FIRST. We Really Won?** (win) and **Oh, We Lost...** (lose with **Charizard last**) are mutually exclusive: lose on the backup, restore, win on the main file.
- Melissa → **Beat the One Who Beat Gary** · Gideon → **You Are the Champion!**
- E4: Lorelei **Ice-Cold Master** · Bruno **Solid-Ground Fighter** · Agatha **Spirit-Tamed Elder** · Lance **Dragon-Fierce Warrior** · Slate **You Were Ready!**

26. Post-Championship (Pallet Party Panic)

- 🎯 **Where It All Began** ⚠️ — defeat **Fearow** in the **sky battle** (needs **Pidgeot**). This is the door out of Kanto.
 - 🛑 **STOP** — confirm every Kanto missable above is done. There is **NO** way back.
- **Orange Islands** (the finish line of what exists)

- 🎯 **Seadra Challenge** ⚠️ — beat **Cissy** (Mikan) with your un-evolved **Squirtle**.
- 🎯 **How Hungry?** ⚠️ — catch the **Snorlax** on **Grapaberry Island**.
- ⚠️ F6 (Tangelo Pokémon Park) & F7 (OI lady scenes): 💾 save before. Content ends ~Gym 3 (Rudy); no Gym 4 / Drake finale exists.

⚠️ **One missable I couldn't pin to a stop: Shed a Tear** — in an **abandoned/deserted Pokémon house**, look at **all 4** Pokémon **without adopting any** and without leaving early. It falls somewhere mid-Kanto; watch for the house.